



to their 20MP front camera. Powered by a Sony sensor and 4500K selfie light, the camera captures sharp details in its selfie mode. AI-powered Beautify 4.0 feature provides intelligent toning of images.

Other features like front camera group shots and selfie timers provide added appeal. In addition, the camera can record videos of up to 1080-pixel resolution at 30 frames per second.

Performance: powerhouse in a budget

With Redmi Note 5 Pro, Xiaomi debuts Snapdragon 636 octa-core chipset. Clock speed is limited to 1.8GHz. Yet, the processor efficiently multitasks and carries off heavy applications and games. Xiaomi says it is 40 per cent faster than Redmi Note 4's Snapdragon 625 chipset. Graphics are driven by a competent Adreno 509 GPU. Coupled with 4GB or 6GB RAM, the processing setup is good enough for the budget. It will be interesting to see if clock speed of the processor improves going forward.

The operating software is the proprietary MIUI 9 interface system running over Android 7.1.1 Nougat—hopefully to be updated to the latest Android Oreo soon. MIUI software has positives in terms of smooth usage, easy applications like split screen and second space, customisation options, coupled with a good

variety of software for various applications.

However, it lacks an app drawer, requiring all applications and folders to be spread across the home screen. While it does not bother me much personally, many users prefer the application drawer for a neater home screen.

Battery capacity is 4000mAh, which is decent. A bigger screen and higher resolution require battery power. Mi claims 8.5 hours of gaming or equivalent phone operations on full charge.

Display: wider display with good colour capture

The 15.2cm (5.99-inch) display is smooth, with contoured edges—hence, termed 2.5-dimensional, or 2.5D—protected by Corning Gorilla Glass. Corners of the screen are curved. This is a change over Redmi Note 4's squared screen, and it looks good!

Xiaomi draws our focus to the 18:9 aspect ratio. This means, when holding it in landscape mode (horizontally), width of the phone is twice that of its height. Aspect ratio earlier was 16:9, implying that Note 5 Pro offers a 12 per cent wider display. This adds a good flavour to playing games or watching video. At 2160 × 1800-pixel (FHD+) resolution, the screen captures good colour details. Display



The camera and fingerprint scanner

configuration can be customised via options provided by MIUI.

Connectivity: more memory or more SIM

Note 5 Pro comes with a hybrid SIM tray. One slot supports a nanoSIM card, while the other supports either a nano-SIM or a microSD card. Personally, this feature is a draw for me. As a professional, two SIM cards come in handy. Whereas, as a media enthusiast, compromising on storage space required for my favourite audio and video files is a hard choice. If you use two SIMs together, both can be 4G enabled. However, the primary SIM supports 4G LTE, while the secondary SIM only catches 3G.

All other major connectivity methods are available as well, including dual-band Wi-Fi support (with 802.11ac standard), Bluetooth 5.0, Bluetooth HID and so on. There is an infrared blaster, too, that can control appliances like televisions or air-conditioners.

There are many more features to explore in Redmi Note 5 Pro. Overall, the phone is a good deal to go ahead with. **EFY**



Gaming on Redmi Note 5 Pro